

markpublish Quick Reference

Configuration and Templates

Reference for every key of markpublish.yaml and the building blocks of a theme.

Version	2.1.6
Date	2026-09-21
Author	Frank Winter
Copyright	© 2026 Frank Winter

markpublish.yaml

Top level: `document`, `theme`, `parts`, optionally `templates_dir`. All paths are relative to the directory of this file. Build with `markpublish build [CONFIG_FILE] [OPTIONS]`.

Structure

There are exactly two structural tiers. Anything deeper is carried by the Markdown file itself.

```
markpublish.yaml
├─ document:      metadata and global switches
├─ theme:         name of the theme
├─ parts:         list of sections
│   └─ part:      name of the section
│       └─ chapters: list of chapters
│           └─ file: one Markdown file
│               └─ # H1  chapter heading
│               └─ ## H2  structure
│               └─ ### H3  inside the file
```

document

Metadata and global layout toggles. Only `title` is required.

Key	Default	Meaning
<code>title</code>	<i>required</i>	Document title (cover page, header, filename)
<code>subtitle</code>	–	Subtitle on the cover page
<code>summary</code>	–	Summary / abstract on the cover page
<code>author</code>	–	Author name
<code>date</code>	<code>auto</code>	Date (<code>auto</code> or <code>today</code> for the build date)
<code>version</code>	–	Version on the cover page and in the footer
<code>status</code>	–	Document status (e.g. <code>Draft</code> , <code>Approved</code>)
<code>copyright</code>	–	Copyright notice on the cover page
<code>language</code>	system language	ISO code for static labels (<code>de</code> , <code>en</code>)
<code>cover</code>	<code>false</code>	Generate a cover page

Key	Default	Meaning
header / footer	true	Running headers and footers
document_toc	full	Main table of contents: none, full or a depth
part_toc	full	Default for part divider pages: none, full or a depth
chapter_toc	full	Default for chapter divider pages: none, full or a depth
autonum_pattern	see <i>Numbering</i>	How numbers are built; slot 1 is the part here
autonum_reset	false	Levels below start again at one when entered
part_label	from i18n	Word before a part number (Part); "" drops it
chapter_label	from i18n	Word before a chapter number (Chapter); "" drops it
pagenum_reset	false	Restart page numbering per part or chapter

Custom fields under document: (department: "R&D") reach the theme through the meta dictionary (meta.at("department").value). Static labels belong in i18n.yaml, not here.

parts

A part brackets chapters and passes settings down to them. Without break_before it does not show itself.

Key	Default	Meaning
part	required	Name of the section
chapters	required	List of chapters in this section
toc_title	part	Title in the main table of contents
divider_title	part	Title on the divider page
subtitle / summary	-	Subtitle and summary on the divider page
break_before	none	divider, page OR none
document_toc	inherited	Contribution to the main TOC; none hides the part
part_toc	inherited	Local TOC on its own divider page
chapter_toc	inherited	Default for the divider pages of its chapters
autonum_pattern	inherited	Numbers of its chapters; slot 1 is the chapter here
autonum_reset	inherited	Chapters of this part start again at one
label	from i18n	Word before its own number

Key	Default	Meaning
chapter_label	inherited	Word before the number of each of its chapters (Appendix)
pagenum_reset	inherited	Restart page numbering at the start of the part

chapters

A chapter is one Markdown file. Its name comes from that file's # heading.

Key	Default	Meaning
file	<i>required</i>	Path to the Markdown file
show_title	true	Show the file's H1 on the content page
toc_title	file H1	Title in the table of contents and running header
divider_title	file H1	Title on the divider page
subtitle / summary	-	Subtitle and summary on the divider page
break_before	page	divider, page OR none
document_toc	inherited	Contribution to the main TOC (<i>none</i> , <i>full</i> , <i>depth</i>)
chapter_toc	inherited	Local TOC on its own divider page
autonum_pattern	inherited	Numbers <i>inside</i> the chapter; slot 1 is the H2 here
autonum_reset	inherited	Headings of this chapter start again at one
label	inherited	Word before its own number (<i>Appendix A: ...</i>)
pagenum_reset	inherited	Restart page numbering at the start of the chapter

Inheritance

Everything marked *inherited* flows from the outside in; the innermost setting wins.

document	→	parts[]	→	chapters[]
autonum_pattern		autonum_pattern		autonum_pattern
autonum_reset		autonum_reset		autonum_reset
document_toc		document_toc		document_toc
part_toc		part_toc		-
chapter_toc		chapter_toc		chapter_toc
pagenum_reset		pagenum_reset		pagenum_reset
part_label		label		-
chapter_label		chapter_label		label

Numbering

A pattern describes the levels *below* the place it stands — so slot 1 shifts with that place.

Level	under document	on a part	on a chapter
Part	slot 1	-	-
Chapter (H1)	slot 2	slot 1	-
H2	slot 3	slot 2	slot 1
H3	slot 4	slot 3	slot 2
⋮	⋮	⋮	⋮
H6	slot 7	slot 6	slot 5

Symbols: 1 → 1, 2, 3 · 01 → 01, 02 · a / A → a, b / A, B · i / I → i, ii / I, II · _ level without a number
· + repeats the slot before it for every deeper level. Slots are separated by |; everything else in a slot is a literal, reserved characters go in single quotes ('Article '1').

on document	"_ 1 .1 +"	part unnumbered · chapter 1 · 1.1
on document	"I 1 .1 +"	Part I · chapters 1, 2, 3 through
on a part	"A .1 +"	chapter A · A.1 · A.1.1
on a part	"'Article '1 ' ('1')'"	Article 1 · Article 1 (2)

Without a setting, "_|1|.1|+" applies: parts unnumbered, chapters 1, 1.1, 1.1.1.

The part number does **not** enter the chapter numbers; a part with document_toc: "none" gets none and consumes none. A notated label steps in front of the heading's number (Appendix A: Schema) without reaching the subheadings (A.1).

Templates and Themes

Everything visible is controlled by a theme: typography, page layout, and static text. The built-in default theme `default` is provided for PDF.

Where Themes Are Located

The first match wins — a theme is always loaded from exactly one source location and never merged across multiple locations. Which theme is used is determined by the `--theme` command-line option or the `theme:` setting in `markpublish.yaml` (default: `default`).

Rank	Location
1. User	<code>~/.markpublish/templates/<theme>/</code> or user-specific AppData directory
2. Project	<code>--templates-dir</code> on CLI, <code>templates_dir:</code> in YAML, <code>MARKPUBLISH_TEMPLATES_DIR</code> , or <code>./templates/<theme>/</code>
3. Package	Built-in standard theme <code>default</code>

`markpublish templates` lists all templates available on the system along with their resolution rank and origin.

Customizing a Theme

```
markpublish export-template default ./templates
```

This command copies the built-in theme files into your project directory, where resolution rank 2 automatically discovers and uses them on the next build. For PDF output, a theme directory contains:

- `template.typ`: Main Typst layout template defining page geometry, headers, footers, and styles
- `i18n.yaml`: Shared label definitions and localized strings across the theme
- `pdf/i18n.yaml`: Format-specific label definitions and string overrides for PDF
- `fonts/`: Optional custom font files (.ttf, .otf) loaded by Typst
- `assets/`: Image assets, logos, and vector icons

Static Labels (i18n)

Labels resolve through a four-stage cascade; a lower level overrides only the keys it explicitly defines:

Level	File
1. Application	markpublish/i18n.yaml (application default strings)
2. Theme	<templates>/<theme>/i18n.yaml
3. Target format	<templates>/<theme>/pdf/i18n.yaml
4. Project	./i18n.yaml next to markpublish.yaml

Each file is organized by language code (de:, en:); the key "*" applies to all languages. Level 4 belongs to the project: it allows overriding labels and localizing custom metadata fields (department: "Department"). Use markpublish labels --overridden or markpublish labels --theme <theme> to inspect the cascade before building.

Key CLI Commands

Command	Key Options	Description
markpublish build	--theme, --target, -o, --templates-dir	Compile document to PDF
markpublish init	[TARGET], --title, --lang	Set up a minimal starter project
markpublish cheatsheet	--lang, --theme, -o, --templates-dir	Generate this quick reference as PDF
markpublish manual	--lang, --theme, -o, --templates-dir	Generate the complete user manual
markpublish templates	--target, --templates-dir	List templates and lookup rank
markpublish export-template	[THEME], [TARGET], --target	Export template files for customization
markpublish labels	--theme, --target, --templates-dir, --overridden	Inspect static labels and metadata